

Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second *IS* the Best

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)

 **Key Verse:** Esther 4:14 (WEB)

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”



Appetizer – Background (Esther 1–3) *summarized*

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.” --Esther 2:17 (WEB)

Queen Vashti was breathtaking, bold, and unapologetically defiant — so when King Ahasuerus (Xerxes) summoned her to show off her beauty, she refused. Her refusal cost her the crown. A kingdom-wide search began for her replacement. Esther, a Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, was chosen and crowned queen — not by luck, but divine placement.

Meanwhile, Haman was promoted, and the king commanded people to bow before him. Everyone complied except Mordecai. His refusal — rooted in the Ten Commandments — enraged Haman, who immediately plotted genocide.

 **CST Reflection:**

Have you ever faced backlash for simply doing the right thing?

Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage

Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Esther 4:13–14 (WEB)

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**’”

Esther learns that her crown cannot shield her from Haman’s decree. Mordecai positions her heart: This is bigger than beauty. Bigger than privilege. This is purpose.

CST Reflection:

When have you realized that your position was actually an assignment?

Bite 2 – The Fast that Shifted History, Esther 4:15–16 (WEB)

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.”

Esther requested a three-day fast — not a last resort, but a spiritual repositioning. Fasting clarifies. Fasting strengthens. Fasting shifts atmospheres. God was aligning Esther’s courage with divine timing.

 *Fasting Note:* Always consult your pastor and doctor before engaging in fasting if you have health concerns.

CST Reflection:

What personal “fear barrier” do you need to fast through?

Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7 (WEB)

“I have given Esther the house of Haman... and they have hanged him... because he stretched out his hand against the Jews.”

The same gallows Haman built for Mordecai became the tool of his own undoing.

When Esther stepped into purpose, God shifted everything:

- A decree reversed
- A nation rescued
- The enemy exposed
- Honor restored

CST Reflection:

Where in your life can God turn evil intentions into divine promotion?

Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Romans 8:28 (WEB)

“We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose.”

Esther didn’t come from royalty — she walked into it through obedience.

God used:

- her identity
- her humility
- her courage
- her fasting
- her placement

...to preserve an entire people. This is not a coincidence. This is covenant protection in action.

To-Go Box — Take This with You

God positions before He promotes.

Purpose requires courage.

Fasting unlocks clarity.

And obedience activates destiny.

Write one sentence you're taking with you:

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for divine placement and divine purpose. Strengthen us like Esther to stand boldly, speak wisely, and obey quickly—even when fear rises. Teach us to fast, to listen, and to move when You call. And remind us that You are the God who turns every evil plot into a testimony of Your power. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Write a short prayer about one thing you want to start praying about:

Review Questions

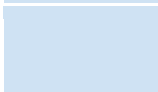
Who was King Ahasuerus’ first wife?

Why were the Jews’ lives threatened?

How long were they called to a fast?

What did Esther risk by going before the king unsummoned?

Activity – Mix & Match

Match		Name/Phrase		Description
	1	Haman	A	Esther's Cousin
	2	Mordecai	B	Wanted to destroy Jews
	3	Vashti	C	Death for coming without summons
	4	Why Fast was called	D	Refused to come when summoned
	5	How Haman died	E	By hanging at the Gallows

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).



Notes & Group Discussion

